

applications), IIS 5.0 Web Server, Exchange 2000 (messaging server), SQL 2000 (database server), etc.

The Facilitators

Going by the requirements, you are probably getting a fair idea of the scope and vastness of the .Net platform. But don't think that this is something you can't do on your own. You can. The only things required are dedication and a lot of hard work. Once you think you are ready, you can walk up to the nearest Microsoft Prometric Institute one fine day and crack the exam.

In case you think you can't, there are people and institutes that can help you. In India, Microsoft has tied up with various institutes to provide training to people who are interested in .Net certification. One such institute is Karrox Technologies. It is offering .Net as part of a comprehensive modular career program called K-Map that spans four semesters. Karrox is not the only one. NIIT and APTECH are also offering .Net certification courses.

That's it then

Now comes the all-important question—what about job prospects? .Net is still in its nascent stage in India. Still, one thing is certain. Sooner rather than later, the demand is going to build

up. Nair adds, "The initial intent is there. Companies are ready to absorb .Net professionals. The demand is going to increase by leaps and bounds once Microsoft releases the first .Net-based operating system, which it should by the end of 2001."

Employment avenues aside, another issue of concern is the remuneration that will be offered. This is because we Indians have this really bad habit of going and doing the same course that our neighbour did. As a result of this, 1,000 job seekers might line up for 50 vacancies. Because of this excess supply in relation to demand, those who finally do get the jobs will end up working for half to one-fourth of what a .Net professional would get in the US. This has happened in the past with jobs related to MCSE/MCSD, Java certification, etc, and it just might happen again.

In any case, if your basic programming concepts are clear, then you should be able to decide whether or not .Net certification is the thing for you.

Visit www.microsoft.com/downloads and download the software (if you have lots of bandwidth, that is) along with the documentation. Play around with the software and let that help you make up your mind about whether or not to go in for the .Net certification. 

Try it out!

Here is a glossary of some of the technical terms

C#: Pronounced as 'C sharp', this is a simple, object-oriented, and type-safe programming language. C# is firmly planted in the C and C++ family tree of languages. C# aims to combine the high productivity of Visual Basic and the raw power of C++.

ASP.NET: A revolutionary new programming framework that enables the rapid development of powerful Web applications and services. Part of the emerging Microsoft .Net platform, it provides the easiest and most scalable way to build, deploy and run distributed Web applications that can target any browser or device.